

University Quality Assurance

University: BIU

Faculty: Education

Department: English

Course Specifications

Program(s) on which the course is given: Undergraduate

Major or minor element of programs: Thesis & Non-Thesis Programs

Department offering the program: English

Department offering the course: English

Academic year: 2017-2018

Semester: Fall

Section: _____

Rm# _____

Date of specification approval (faculty council): 2002

A- Basic Information

Title: Composition and Research Skills

Code: ENGL 201

Credit Hours: 3 cr.

Lecture/Week: Twice – MW ; TTh

Tutorial/Week: NA

Practical/ Week: 2

Duration (No. of weeks): 15 Weeks

Names of lecturers contributing in the course: Lina Shami (Course Coordinator); BIU
ENGL201 Team

B- Professional Information

1- Overall Aims of Course

ENGL 201 *Composition and Research Skills* builds upon the skills acquired in pre-requisite courses mainly ENGL 151 to further develop students' critical thinking and academic writing competencies. Students will read and respond to a variety of texts from different disciplines and produce a research essay using analytical and critical skills in response to texts.

2- Intended Learning Outcomes of Course (ILOs)

A- Knowledge and Understanding:

- A.1: Identify basic elements that guide students to develop essay writing
- A.2: Develop research skills
- A.3: Proofread and edit sentences
- A.4: Identify/ practice pre-writing techniques
- A.5: Demonstrate clear knowledge of different patterns of organization

B- Intellectual Skills:

- B.1: Produce rhetorical methods of essay development.
- B.2: Reflect on and analyze selected readings and relate possible themes to personal experience
- B.3: Synthesize different sources

C- Professional and Practical Skills

- C.1: Write a paragraph with main idea and supporting details that are relevant, coherent, and adequate
- C.2: Write with varied and effective academic vocabulary and mastery of correct word forms
- C.3: Write a range of rhetorical modes, focusing on a particular mode and developing the essay accordingly
- C.4: Incorporate and cite different sources to produce a researched essay
- C.5: Summarize and paraphrase sources to avoid plagiarism
- C.6: Use APA style
- C.7: Use PowerPoint to present their work

D- General and Transferrable Skills

- D.1: Relate knowledge acquired to actual academic settings
- D.2: Use researched skills to write researched –based essays on any topic of interest

3- Contents: Fall 2017-18 ENGL201 Syllabus

Week	Units/ Material to be covered - Longman Academic Writing Series (4) - Supplementary material attached	Assignments <u>Suggested Exercises:</u>	Quizzes/Exams/ Projects/Comments
W1; D1	- Introduction to the course - Discussion of the syllabus		
W1; D2	- Diagnostic Essay: Students write an essay on a given topic - Introduce the Writing Process		Diagnostic Essay: Teacher can refer to the suggested topic included in the detailed <i>Assessment Guide</i>
W2; D1	Chapter 1 : Elements of paragraph writing	Practice 1 (Model) Practice 2 p.6 Practice 3 p. 7 Practice 4 &5 p.9 Practice 6 p.13 Practice 9 p. 16	Writing effective topic sentences, supporting details and concluding sentences
W2; D2	Chapter 2: Unity and Coherence	Practice 1 (Model) p.23 Practice 2 &3 p. 25 & 26 (irrelevant sentences) p. 27 (key words) Practice 4 p. 28 Practice 5 p. 29 & Practice 6 p. 30 (pronouns)	- Emphasis on irrelevant sentences. - Emphasis on using key words, synonyms and pronouns as elements of coherence
W3; D1	Chapter 2 continued : Transitional words & elements of coherence	Practice 7 p. 31 (Transitions) Practice 8 p. 36 Practice 9 p. 37, 38 Practice 10: p. 39 (Editing) Practice 11 p. 40, 41 (Logical order)	Students need to use the different types of transitional words properly to link sentences and ideas.
W3; D2	Chapter 4: Writing introductions, thesis statements, body paragraphs	Model p. 75: Writing Introductions Practice 2 p. 80, 81 Practice 3 p. 82,83 Writing Thesis Statements: Practice 4&5 p. 83&84 Writing Body paragraphs & types of evidence p. 86	In class: teacher choses a topic to which students have to write a) an introduction b) thesis statement c) topic sentences and supporting details-outline form
W4; D1	Chapter 4 continued: Writing Concluding Paragraphs and Transitional Sentences Outlining	Types of conclusions: p 87 Practice 6 p. 88 Practice 7 p. 90 Practice 8 p. 92 Transitional sentences:	d) conclusion * Students can modify topic sentence 2 & topic sentence 3 to replace them with transitional sentences

		p.93, 94 Practice 9 p. 94,95 Outlining: p. 96 practice 10	
W 4; D2	Chapter 6: Cause /Effect Essay	Models I & II Practice 2 p. 122 (Block method) Practice 3 p. 124 (Chain method) Practice 4 p. 125 Practice 5 p. 126 Practice 6 p.127,128	Quiz I: Chapters 1,2 & 4
W5; D1	Chapter 6: Cause /Effect Essay continued	Sample Essay	Graded Assignment: Cause-Effect Essay
W5; D2	Chapter 9: - Conjunctions: *Coordinating *Subordination *Correlative *Conjunctive adverbs	Modal: p. 171,171 Practice 1 p. 174 Practice 2 &3 p. 177,178 Practice 4 p. 180 Practice 5 & 6 p. 181 Practice 8 p. 184 Practice 9 p. 186 Editing p. 187	Students have to join sentences using the different types of conjunctions.
W6; D1	Chapter 10: Run-ons, Comma splices, Faulty Parallelism & Fragments	Practice 1 A & B p. 192,193 Practice 2 A& B p. 195 Practice 4 p. A, B & C 199,200	Students are expected to avoid sentence faults.
W6; D2	Chapter 7 : Compare/Contrast	Model : p.134 Point by point: p. 138 Block Method: p. 138/139 Outlining Compare-Contrast: p. 140	Quiz II: Chapters 9 & 10 Teacher can choose two YouTube videos, TedX talks, magazine articles or any other form of media so that students can write an outline in which they highlight similarities/differences.
W7; D1	Compare/Contrast Essay	Practice 4: p 142 Practice 7:p 145 Sample Essay	Graded Assignment: Compare/Contrast
W7; D2	Revision for Midterm	Sample: Cause-Effect Sample: Compare-Contrast	
W8; D1	Midterm Expected Date: November 28 &29		
W8; D2	Chapter 3: Paraphrasing & Summarizing	Model I; paraphrase p. 58, 59,60,61 Practice 6 p. 62 Practice 7 p. 63	The purpose of chapter 3 is to curb plagiarism.

W 9; D 1	Chapter 3 <i>continued</i>: Paraphrasing & Summarizing	Model II; Summary p. 66 Practice 8 p. 68 Practice 9	Suggested Assignment: Teacher chooses an article from (The Independent, The Guardian, CNN, BBC, NYT, etc...). Students have to: a) write a summary of the entire text; b) paraphrase one paragraph.
W9; D2	Chapter 8: Argumentative Essay	Model I : Point by Point Pattern p. 153 Point by point outlining p. 157 Practice 3 p. 159	Focus on writing the claim- Thesis, reasoning and refutation.
W10; D2	Chapter 8 continued: Argumentative Essay	Model II: Block Method	Focus on writing the claim- thesis, reasoning and refutation. Highlight differences between the two different models.
W10; D2	Chapter 8 <i>continued</i> : Argumentative Essay	- Supporting Details - Inductive and Deductive Reasoning	Students solve the attached exercise (in the book) for a better understanding of the difference between the two types of reasoning.
W11; D1	Argumentative Essay Continued	Sample Argumentative essay	Writing Assignment: Argumentative Essay
W11; D2	Introduction to the Researched Essay	Brain storming of Argumentative topics & Sample Outlining	Students need to choose a research topic – to be approved by the instructor – with 4/5 resources/references
W12; D1	Introduction to the researched essay continued	APA style	Quiz III: Argumentation: induction, deduction, supporting evidence, refutation
W12; D2	Introduction to the researched essay continued	Teacher models to student the process of writing a researched essay with in-text citation and referencing	
			It is a Researched Essay and <u>not</u> paper. As such, it has to follow the same format covered in class for writing an argumentative essay. It MUST not exceed 2000 words.
W13; D1	Introduction to the researched essay continued	In class, students write a detailed outline for their researched essay. Detailed discussion of “From Stigma to Statues” : Sample Researched Essay	Students need to highlight the different elements of the researched essay as used in the sample.

W13; D2	Argumentation	Analysis of an argumentative text	Tips on giving a presentation and preparing a PPP.
W14; D1	Presentations		
W14 D2	Presentations		<u>Researched Essay due</u>
W15	Overall revision + Sample Final Exam		

4- Teaching and Learning Methods

4.1: Lectures

4.2: Presentations

4.3: Group Discussions

4.4: Writings (Essay Writing, Homework, Classwork)

5- Student Assessment Methods

5.1: Discussion of a variety of topics to assess students' understanding of the taught content

5.2: Presentations of the Researched Essay to assess students' argumentative skills

5.3: Essays to assess students' application of the writing skills

Assessment Schedule

Assessment 1: Diagnostic Essay; Week 1

Assessment 2: Quiz I; Week 4

Assessment 3: Cause-Effect; Essay Week 5

Assessment 4: Quiz II; Week 6

Assessment 5: Compare-Contrast Essay Week 7

Assessment 6: Midterm; Week 8

Assessment 7: Argumentative Essay; Week 11

Assessment 8: Quiz III; Week 12

Assessment 9: Presentations and Researched Essay due; Week 14

Weightage of Formative and Summative Assessments

Attendance and Participation	10%	
Essays / Quizzes	20 %	3 essays & 3 quizzes
Mid-Term	25%	
Research Paper/presentation	20%	RP= 10% PR= 10%
Final Exam	25%	
Total	100%	

6- List of References

6.1- Essential book (Textbook)

Longman Academic Writing Series 4: Essays

Authors: Oshima, A. & Hogue, A

Publisher: Pearson

COURSE PREREQUISITE: ENGL 151

7- Facilities Required for Teaching and Learning

LCD Projector / Audio-Visual Devices / E-mail Correspondence / Office Meetings

Course Coordinator: Lina Shami

Dean of SoED: Dr. Anwar Kawtharani

Date: September 2017

